

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's *1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "*1974 Recommendation*") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The *1974 Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the *1974 Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the *1974 Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the *1974 Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the *1974 Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the *1974 Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (**Table 1**). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended “*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*”. Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

- 1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
- 2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes

3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations
 - 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>

8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs. It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>
Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not</i>

	<i>recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>
Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Germany

Organization:

Federal Foreign Office

Date of submission:

08.02.2021

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Secretariat of the Standing Conference of the Ministers of Education and Cultural Affairs of the Länder in the Federal Republic of Germany (KMK)
Federal Ministry of Education and Research (BMBF)
Federal Ministry for Family Affairs, Senior Citizens, Women and Youth (BMFSFJ)
Secretariat of the Conference of Ministers for Youth and Family Affairs of the Länder in the Federal Republic of Germany (Geschäftsstelle der Jugend- und Familienministerkonferenz, JFMK)

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Others (please specify):

German Commission for UNESCO

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Human rights education, as well as education instilling tolerance and democratic citizenship, are anchored in the school legislation of the individual Länder. All Länder view education to respect human dignity and transmit the values set out in Germany's Basic Law as a substantial task of schools. In this way, schools enable the free development of the personality of each individual and do everything they can to create equal opportunities and compensate for disadvantages. In this connection, each person, irrespective of their origin or social standing, has the right to an appropriate education. Furthermore, the Länder accept the primary right of participation of parents in the education of their children and include them in their activities as a second pillar of educational work.

In Germany, early childhood education and care is part of the public welfare system, for which the Federal Government, the 16 Federal States (Länder) and municipalities/local authorities share responsibility.

Pursuant to Book Eight of the German Social Code, every young person in Germany has the right to have their development fostered and to be educated to become a responsible individual capable of playing their role in the community. Youth welfare services help to realise this right. Based on the common understanding of all Länder, the Gemeinsame Rahmen der Länder für die frühe Bildung in Kindertageseinrichtungen (common framework of the Länder for early education in child daycare centres) sets out the educational principles in child daycare centres, which are part of youth welfare services. These principles are ultimately fleshed out in the education plans at Land level, taking into consideration differences and forms of implementation in line with the specific situation in each Land. The education plans of the individual Länder are orientation frameworks of a binding nature for the Land in question. On the basis of this plan, daycare centres draw up strategies which take into account local conditions and the specific philosophies of the governing organisation or centre.

Taking the findings of developmental psychology into consideration, daycare centres with their holistic mandate to educate, their orientation towards the child's world and the good opportunities they offer for children to take part, due to their participative understanding, are suitable places for shaping and facilitating the education of children. The main focus of their commitment to educate lies in strengthening the individual competences of young children and their disposition to learn, fostering a linguistic education integrated into daily life, increasing, supporting and encouraging children's urge to explore, fostering values, showing children how to learn, as well as helping them to find their place in the world in social contexts. Furthermore, daycare centres have a mandate to practise inclusion as a comprehensive educational principle and to offer all children the chance to have a good start in life and to develop. The aim is to enable them to participate in society, to foster a self-determined life and to ensure that all children are able to communicate and interact in different areas of life.

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

Germany's National Sustainable Development Strategy

(<https://www.bundesregierung.de/resource/blob/997532/188836/7d1716e5d5576bec62c9d16ca908e80e/2017-06-20-nachhaltigkeit-neuauflage-engl-data.pdf?download=1>)

For an overview of laws, legislations or legal frameworks referring to GCED and ESD at national and federal level please consider the results of the German monitoring research on ESD:

Holst, J.; Brock, A.; Singer-Brodowski, M.; de Haan, G. (2020): Monitoring Progress of Change: Implementation of Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) within Documents of the German Education System. Sustainability 2020, 12, 4306. (English): <https://www.mdpi.com/2071-1050/12/10/4306>

Early Childhood education and care (extract, not definitive)

- UN Convention on the Rights of the Child: <https://www.unicef.de/informieren/ueber-uns/fuer-kinderrechte/un-kinderrechtskonvention>

Laws at federal level:

- Book Eight of the Social Code: http://www.gesetze-im-internet.de/sgb_8/

Orientation framework for all 16 Länder:

- Gemeinsamer Rahmen der Länder für die frühe Bildung in Kindertageseinrichtungen (common framework of the Länder for early education in child daycare centres) (is currently being updated)

Laws and regulations, education plans and guidelines – e.g. Bavaria:

- Bayerisches Kinderbildungs- und -betreuungsgesetz (Bavarian child education and care act) (BayKiBiG) <https://www.gesetze-bayern.de/Content/Document/BayKiBiG>
- Kinderbildungsverordnung zum BayKiBiG (AVBayKiBiG) (child education regulation on the BayKiBiG) <https://www.gesetze-bayern.de/Content/Document/BayAVKiBiG>
- Bayerischer Bildungs- und Erziehungsplan für Kinder in Tageseinrichtungen bis zur Einschulung (BayBEP) (Bavarian education plan for children in daycare centres until enrolment at school) <https://www.ifp.bayern.de/veroeffentlichungen/books/bildungs-erziehungsplan/>
- Handreichung Bildung, Erziehung und Betreuung von Kindern in den ersten drei Lebensjahren (guide on the education and care of children in the first three years) https://www.ifp.bayern.de/projekte/curricula/handreicherung_U3.php
- Bayerische Bildungsleitlinien für die Bildung und Erziehung von Kindern bis zum Ende der Grundschulzeit (BayBL) (Bavarian education guidelines for the education of children until the end of primary school) https://www.ifp.bayern.de/imperia/md/content/stmas/ifp/bayerische_bildungsleitlinien.pdf

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	99	99			1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	99	99			1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	99	99			1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	99	99			1	1	9	1
5. Climate change	99	99			1	1	9	1
6. Environmental sustainability	99	99			1	1	9	1
7. Human survival and well-being	99	99			1	1	9	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	99	99			1	1	9	1

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The principles of the 1974 Recommendation are incorporated into the National Plan of Action for ESD (2017), with a view to scaling up and mainstreaming ESD in all areas of education as part of the implementation of the UNESCO Global Action Programme (2015-2019), the follow-up programme ESD for 2030 and SDG 4.7.

The German Federal Government together with the Länder attaches considerable political importance to the national implementation of ESD. In its role as lead ministry, the Federal Ministry on Education and Research has established a National Platform with support structures. The National Platform as supreme steering body adopted a National Action Plan on ESD (NAP) in June 2017 as its main contribution to the implementation of the UNESCO Programmes in Germany. It defines 130 objectives and 349 measures. It was developed in a multi-stakeholder process drawing upon the expertise of members of the National Platform as well as input from over 300 organisations and experts, working together in six expert forums (Early Childhood Education, School, Vocational Education and Training, Higher Education, Informal and Non-Formal Learning, Local Authorities) and additional partner networks. Since the

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

adoption of the NAP in June 2017 German stakeholders have submitted more than 309 commitments to implement the National Action Plan; they are continuously invited to do so. https://www.bmbf.de/files/BMBF_NAP_BNE_EN_Screen.pdf. To strengthen the role of youth participation, the ministry implemented and finances a youth forum. Its members are represented in the National Platform and in the Expert Forums. They serve as change agents to further motivate other young people for ESD and have therefore their own budget to implement ESD and organize conferences.

ESD is increasingly seen as a key task of the school system by the Land Ministries of Education. ESD has now been established as cross-cutting task in schools alongside the existing promotion or support of competitions, events and one-off actions. A growing number of Länder believe it is important to anchor ESD in legislation or in regulatory provisions: inter alia in Berlin's Schools Act, Hamburg's "ESD Masterplan", ESD as "a special educational task" in Hesse's Schools Act (new version of 30 June 2017, section 6 paragraph 4), the administrative regulations on ESD at schools providing general education in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania's Schools Act (sections 3 and 5), the ESD decree in Lower Saxony scheduled for 2019, the anchoring of ESD in Saxony-Anhalt's Schools Act and Saxony's Schools Act of 26 April 2017 (section 1 paragraph 6), Berlin's Schools Act (in particular section 3 paragraph 3), the "Future Concept for ESD 2015+" in Rhineland-Palatinate. Moreover, (further) Land ESD strategies were drawn up: North Rhine-Westphalia (revision of its strategy "Education for Sustainable Development – the Future of Learning in North Rhine-Westphalia (2016-2020)" from 2019), Saxony's ESD strategy of 22 January 2019, Schleswig-Holstein, the "Future Concept ESD 2015+" in Rhineland-Palatinate, "Framework Curricula 1-10" in Berlin, Hamburg's "ESD Masterplan". Ten Länder are currently receiving support (funded posts) for Land coordination for ESD and global learning from the Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development with support from Engagement Global (Baden-Württemberg, Berlin, Hamburg, Hesse, Lower Saxony, North Rhine-Westphalia, Rhineland-Palatinate, Saarland, Saxony, Schleswig-Holstein).

In 2018, taking into account current societal and political developments as well as the impact of digitalisation, the Standing Conference (KMK) reviewed and updated its recommendation on education for democratic citizenship ("Democracy as objective, subject and practice of historical and political education in schools"). In the same year, the Standing Conference also updated its recommendation on HRE in schools. HRE is considered a cross-cutting issue and a central element of school life.

The overwhelming majority of Länder have sustainable development strategies, initiatives, masterplans or guidelines, in which the spheres of science, research and universities are expressly included and in which ESD plays a special role and cross-sectoral sustainable development goals are being pursued. In some Länder, these strategies or guidelines are currently being updated and fine-tuned with the help of the Science Ministries, inter alia in interministerial working groups. Some examples of this are the updating of Thuringia's sustainable development strategy (2018) and Brandenburg's strategy (2019), as well as the adoption of Land strategies in Saxony (January 2019) and in Saxony-Anhalt (2019).

GCED and ESD also play a role in the sphere of general and political education and are anchored in curricula.

The ESD initiative also focuses on aspects of early child education and puts forward proposals on what measures can strengthen ESD in child daycare centres and other forms of childcare. For example, ESD should be anchored in the education plans of the Länder, but also become an integral part in the field of further and advanced training.

A3b. **Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.**

KMK recommendation “Democracy as objective, subject and practice of historical and political education in schools” (updated 2018),
https://www.kmk.org/fileadmin/Dateien/veroeffentlichungen_beschluesse/2009/2009_03_06-Demokratiebildung-engl.pdf.pdf, in English

KMK recommendation on HRE in schools (updated 2018),
https://www.kmk.org/fileadmin/Dateien/pdf/PresseUndAktuelles/2018/Beschluss_Menschenrechtserziehung.pdf, in German

Joint recommendation KMK and German Commission for UNESCO on ESD at schools:
https://www.kmk.org/fileadmin/Dateien/veroeffentlichungen_beschluesse/2007/2007_06_15_Bildung_f_nachh_Entwicklung.pdf

Inter alia, integration into Berlin’s Schools Act (in particular section 3 paragraph 3), ESD as “a special educational task” in Hesse’s Schools Act (new version of 30 June 2017, section 6 paragraph 4), the administrative regulations on ESD at schools providing general education in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania’s Schools Act (sections 3 and 5), the ESD decree in Lower Saxony, the anchoring of ESD in Saxony-Anhalt’s Schools Act and Saxony’s Schools Act of 26 April 2017 (section 1 paragraph 6), the “Future Concept for ESD 2015+” in Rhineland-Palatinate.

Moreover, (further) Land ESD strategies were drawn up: North Rhine-Westphalia (revision of its strategy “Education for Sustainable Development – the Future of Learning in North Rhine-Westphalia (2016-2020)” from 2019), Saxony’s ESD strategy of 22 January 2019, Schleswig-Holstein, the “Future Concept ESD 2015+” in Rhineland-Palatinate, “Framework Curricula 1-10” in Berlin, Hamburg’s “ESD Masterplan”.

In many Länder, programmes in ESD for pioneering schools are being supported. In some cases, these are being run as Land initiatives with the participation of NGOs as school partners: “Schools of the Future – Education for Sustainable Development” in North Rhine-Westphalia, “Global Learning Schools in the Lausitz” (Brandenburg), “Schools for the Environment” in Hesse, “Sustainable Development Schools” in Thuringia, “ESD Schools” in Rhineland-Palatinate, “Climate Schools” in Saxony, “Eco-Schools” or Centres in Saxony-Anhalt, “Schools for the Environment in Europe –International Sustainable Development Schools” in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, “Climate Schools”, inter alia in Saxony and Hamburg, “Model Schools in Sustainable Development/Learning in Global Contexts” in Berlin. Furthermore, national programmes such as the UNESCO Associated Schools, UNESCO Baltic Sea Associated Schools, the consumer schools (Federation of German Consumer Organisations (vzbv)), the Fair Trade Schools, EMAS Schools (Baden-Württemberg) and Global Learning Schools in the Lausitz (Brandenburg) are being supported.

Guidelines: ESD at adult education institutions
<https://www.volkshochschule.de/medien/downloads/verbandswelt/programmbereich/gesellschaft-politik-und-umwelt/Bildung-fuer-nachhaltige-Entwicklung-an-Volkshochschulen.pdf>

<https://www.dvv-international.de/vhs-kooperationen/globales-lernen>

Early education and care

In the current version of the Gemeinsame Rahmen der Länder für die frühe Bildung in Kindertageseinrichtungen (common framework of the Länder for early education in child daycare centres), the importance of environmental education and ESD as a separate field of education is stressed. Sustainable lifestyles and basic attitudes can be taught especially effectively to children. Environmental education and ESD issues should be meaningfully integrated into the daily routine of daycare centres in a way which is appropriate to the age and development stage of the children. The teaching staff have to act as role models here. By addressing environmental and ESD issues, children, their parents and teachers are able to judge how their own actions and actions within society can impact on life and future generations.

Bavaria as an example:

In Bavaria, environmental education is firmly anchored as a binding education goal in the Bayerisches Kinderbildungs- und -betreuungsgesetz (Bavarian child education and care act) (BayKiBiG). The Bayerischer Bildungs- und Erziehungsplan für Kinder in Tageseinrichtungen bis zur Einschulung (BayBEP) (Bavarian education plan for children in daycare centres until enrolment at school) contains both theoretical background knowledge and fundamental ideas on this area, as well as examples of the successful implementation of this issue in the sphere of early education.

- *A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	
3. Human rights	1	1	1	
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	9	
5. Climate change	1	1	1	
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	9	
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	

*A5. Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	99	99		
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	99		
Textbook development	99	99		
Teacher education and training	99	99		
Assessment of student outcomes	99	99		
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	99	1	1	0
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	1	1	0
Textbook development	99	1	99	0
Teacher education and training	99	1	99	1
Assessment of student outcomes	99	1	1	0

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the 1974 Recommendation)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁴ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Human Rights Education (HRE)

The timetables of the Länder set out in which subjects there can and should be a special focus on HRE, and how many hours of weekly instruction are to be devoted to this in each grade. Here, subjects such as religion, ethics, philosophy, history, civics and social studies are particularly important, as well as economics/politics, geography and German. While values and standards as well as the dignity of the human being can be discussed in subjects such as religion, ethics and philosophy, it is often totalitarian systems which are the subject of debate in history. The concepts of slavery, suppression and race ideology are contrasted with the values of enlightenment, freedom and equality. In social studies, the ideals underlying our understanding of democracy such as free and fair elections can be taught and the subject of social inequality or terrorism can be raised. Subjects in which economics dominates provide the opportunity to take up the social market economy or the concept of ubiquitous globalisation and problems in this connection, while in the subject of German, literary texts that extend into the above contexts can be studied and reflected upon. The subject of geography, too, has its place here with its issues relating to developing countries, the nature of other cultures as well as the (unequal) distribution of the earth's resources and raw materials.

⁴ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

Despite the diversity of content cited here as examples of HRE in the individual subjects, it is in most cases left to the schools or their subject conferences themselves to choose a platform for teaching human rights. The principle applies that the subject of human rights can be taken up in all grades, if content and methods appropriate for the age and maturity of the pupils are used that are also suitable for the grade in terms of their level and degree of difficulty.

There are hand-outs and various publications to support schools in carrying out human rights education. There are also many different suitable school books from which schools or subject conferences must select.

To ensure efficient teaching also in the context of human rights education, most Länder have taken special measures that are tailored to this issue, and that include in-service training for teachers and subject-specific symposia and teaching conferences. Other measures are taken during teacher training, where the subject of human rights as a cross-sectional subject receives special attention. At an institutional level, targeted measures have been included in reformed framework curricula and guidelines, as well as school-specific legislation. In addition, the Länder as a rule endeavour to support schools and teachers through regular newsletters and suitable Internet materials. The schools, in turn, have the opportunity – by carrying out projects, project days or weeks, but also through the development of school partnerships and a commitment to developing countries – to highlight their understanding of social interdependencies. Here, further options are presented by providing corresponding placements, taking up sponsorships, as well as supporting institutions that work in development assistance, for example, the UNESCO ASP schools. In this way, schools are given the opportunity, beyond collaboration with the institutions of the Länder, to build up contacts with non-school partners. Some examples are: UNICEF and UNESCO, the Central Federal Office for Political Education and the individual Land offices, as well as partners from private business, church organisations, universities and social institutions in general.

ESD

Different approaches have emerged: For example, ESD is named as one of six guiding perspectives in Baden-Württemberg's education plan. In Berlin-Brandenburg, ESD and global learning is one of 13 cross-cutting themes in the "Framework Curricula 1-10", the new framework curricula. North Rhine-Westphalia has developed guidelines on ESD which will serve as a point of reference for future curricula, guidelines etc. Baden-Württemberg has similar plans. In Schleswig-Holstein, curricula commissions are currently devising an "ESD basic curriculum". ESD is touched upon in many subjects within the curricula of all Länder. However, the depth of the focus differs, as does the definition of ESD. ESD is part of the curriculum of subjects such as general studies in primary schools, geography within the scope of social sciences and biology within the context in natural sciences in secondary schools. ESD is also to be found in framework documents focusing on education goals. In Bavaria, ESD was included in the Lehramtsprüfungordnung (LPO I) (examination regulations for trainee teachers; section 33 in LPO I, regulations for the first examination for trainee teachers at state schools). In Hamburg, ESD is integrated into teacher training in all subjects (printed paper 21/11562 of 9 January 2018). In Hesse, ESD is taught (in different forms) at the five universities which train teachers. Since 2018, the framework curricula in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania have been revised for all school forms, also with regard to ESD as a cross-cutting task. In many Länder, the "Curriculum Framework: Education for Sustainable Development" adopted by the Standing Conference (KMK) and the Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ) is used.

ESD is incorporated in many different ways into the structures in each Land. It is noticeable that as well as the integration into existing structures and projects, new structures have been established in some cases (e.g. coordination offices, working groups, contact points in the educational administrations and Land institutes, as well as regional and school-level advisory

systems). Moreover, this cross-cutting theme is often dealt with by different ministries in the Länder and is being increasingly integrated in some Länder as a thematic priority in the sustainable development strategy. Furthermore, the participative aspects as well as concrete cooperation with civil society players have been reflected in the formation of networks, round tables and ESD working groups. These activities are complemented by the drafting of action plans as well as concrete implementation initiatives in the education sphere.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

See above. Please also refer to the 2017 KMK Report „Zur Situation und zu Perspektiven der Bildung für nachhaltige Entwicklung“ ([LINK](#), pp. 40 et seq.)

Together with the Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (BMZ), the Standing Conference (KMK) developed a Curriculum Framework Education for Sustainable Development (2nd edition published in 2016). The framework will shortly be updated to include upper secondary education, <https://www.globaleslernen.de/de/orientierungsrahmen-globale-entwicklung-or>

*B2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***B3** Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	9	1	1	1
History	1	1	1	1	9	9	1	9
Languages	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Mathematics								
Religious education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Science	1	1	1	9	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Other (please specify)								

***B4** Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	1
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	1
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	1

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

HRE: To ensure efficient teaching also in the context of human rights education, most Länder have taken special measures that include in-service training for teachers, subject-specific symposia and teaching conferences. Other measures are taken during teacher training, where the subject of human rights as a cross-sectional subject receives special attention.

ESD: Depending on the higher education legislation of the Länder, the instruments with regard to the compulsory inclusion of ESD in teacher training courses or general study courses differ. The situation varies from Land to Land. In the first and second phases, ESD is included in some Länder, inter alia Hamburg (ESD in the education courses for trainee teachers), Bavaria (ESD in the examination regulations for trainee teachers (LPO I), first state examination), Rhineland-Palatinate (inter alia as a cross-cutting issue in education studies) and Baden-Württemberg (compulsory learning of cross-cutting competences in ESD in all teacher training courses). For the second phase, attention is drawn to the Berlin initiative with, among other things, regular study days for trainee teachers or the elective "Global Learning" module. In addition to this, there are ESD certificate courses in various Länder, among others in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, Schleswig-Holstein, Saarland and Lower Saxony. There are activities in the sphere of further and advanced training for teachers aimed at integrating ESD in all Länder. There are diverse programmes in the sphere of further and advanced training for teachers, inter alia the online further training course "Massive Open Online Course" (MOOC) vis-à-vis the guiding perspectives in Baden-Württemberg, the multi-phase strategy for implementing ESD in teacher training in Hamburg, ESD and Further Training for Teachers II, together with all five regional administrations and the Ministry of Education of North Rhine-Westphalia (start on 1 March

2019), ESD certificate courses and teaching posts by IQ (Integration through Qualification) in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, ESD certificates in planning at the Leuphana University in Lower Saxony.

ESD has become a cross-cutting task in early education. The staff in child daycare centres have to be trained accordingly. In its “Action Area III: Integrating ESD into initial and further training for ECCE professionals”, the Standing Conference has set the goal of including ESD as part of the training at vocational schools. In order to further define the content of the training of daycare centre teachers, the Länder developed a framework curriculum for vocational schools in this field. This was published in June 2020 and also contains binding points of reference to ESD as a key aspect in the training of early education professionals.

BMBF supports the development of the whole institution approach for early childhood care and education institutes; 29 model networks supported by the foundation “Haus der kleinen Forscher” (Little scientists’ house) provide pedagogical resources and a continuous professional development programme. In this context, training workshops for caring/ teaching staff on the integration of ESD in early childhood education are offered. The foundation reaches more than 30.000 early childhood education institutions throughout Germany.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

In the first and second phases, ESD is included in some Länder, inter alia Hamburg (ESD in the education courses for trainee teachers), Bavaria (ESD in the examination regulations for trainee teachers (LPO I), first state examination), Rhineland-Palatinate (inter alia as a cross-cutting issue in education studies) and Baden-Württemberg (compulsory learning of cross-cutting competences in ESD in all teacher training courses). For the second phase, attention is drawn to the Berlin initiative with, among other things, regular study days for trainee teachers or the elective “Global Learning” module. In addition to this, there are ESD certificate courses in various Länder, among others in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, Schleswig-Holstein, Saarland and Lower Saxony. There are diverse programmes in the sphere of further and advanced training for teachers, inter alia the online further training course “Massive Open Online Course” (MOOC) vis-à-vis the guiding perspectives in Baden-Württemberg, the multi-phase strategy for implementing ESD in teacher training in Hamburg, ESD and Further Training for Teachers II, together with all five regional administrations and the Ministry of Education of North Rhine-Westphalia (start on 1 March 2019), ESD certificate courses and teaching posts by IQ (Integration through Qualification) in Mecklenburg-Western Pomerania, ESD certificates in planning at the Leuphana University in Lower Saxony.

Furthermore, in the 2015 joint recommendation of the German Rectors’ Conference and the Standing Conference (KMK), “Educating teachers to embrace diversity” the Standing Conference stated that teachers need professional competences to allow them to identify pupils’ special gifts and any disadvantages, impediments and other obstacles they might exhibit or experience and put in place appropriate pedagogical measures for prevention or support. Therefore, degree programmes which lead to a teaching position in any type of school and at any level of schooling should prepare prospective teachers to take a constructive and professional approach to diversity. This, among other things, will pave the way for human rights education in schools. Recommendation by the German Rectors’ Conference on ESD (“Towards a culture of sustainability”), 2018:

- *C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	99	1	99	
For teachers of other subjects	99	1	99	
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	99	1	99	
For teachers of other subjects	99	1	99	

- *C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	99	
2. Gender equality	1	1	99	
3. Human rights	1	1	99	
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	99	
5. Climate change	1	1	99	
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	99	
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	99	
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	99	

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	99	
Skills	1	1	99	
Values	1	1	99	
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	99	

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

Knowledge, skills and attitudes are covered in "Global Competence in PISA 2018" published by the OECD in Oct 2020.

*D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	99	1	1	
2. Gender equality	99	1	1	
3. Human rights	99	1	1	
4. Peace and non-violence	99	1	1	
5. Climate change	99	1	1	
6. Environmental sustainability	99	1	1	
7. Human survival and well-being	99	1	1	
8. Sustainable consumption and production	99	1	1	

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	99	1	1	
Skills	99	1	1	
Values	99	1	1	
Attitudes and behaviours	99	0	1	

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	99	99		
(b) Curricula	99	99		
(c) Teacher education	99	99		
(d) Student assessment	99	99		
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	2	2	2	2
(b) Curricula	2	2	2	2
(c) Teacher education	2	2	99	
(d) Student assessment	99	2	2	

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 Recommendation)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

Professional training is very much geared to the realities of the labour market and is practice-oriented, ensuring that trainees will subsequently find employment or be able to train further in the course of their professional life. All professions are affected to different degrees by ESD issues. Many stakeholders are involved in shaping vocational training. All of them discuss ESD issues, as well as implement and further develop them. In 2020, it was decided to make environmental protection and sustainable development a standard part of vocational training. Sustainable development is thus firmly integrated into vocational training.

<https://www.bmbf.de/de/karliczek-digitalisierung-und-nachhaltigkeit-kuenftig-pflichtprogramm-fuer-auszubildende-11049.html>

On behalf of the Federal Ministry of Education and Research (BMBF) the Federal Institute for Vocational Education and Training (BIBB) funds joint projects aiming to anchor sustainable development in vocational education and training under the pilot project funding priority "Vocational Education and Training for Sustainable Development (ESD-VET; BBNE)". The current projects run from 2015-2019 (and they are extended until 2021).

The corresponding research and development activities include elaborating schemes for sustainable competence development of apprentices and teaching/training staff, e.g. in commercial and nutrition sectors and in crafts and industries, as well as an initiative on the sustainable design of learning venues in companies and schools. By now 18 projects had been selected and a total of more than 50 training methods and modules have been developed, implemented in practice and evaluated. More than 200 companies are already involved into the projects.

The efforts are encompassed by the development of competence schemes for company owners and managers, especially in SMEs.

As a result the federal initiative ESD-VET provides research based didactic concepts which come along with recommendations for sustainability in VET at the level of regulations, learning processes and teaching practices.

In November 2020 further projects started (within the funding line „transfer“) and focus on the transfer of the results of elaborated concepts for sustainable competence development in order to further train teaching and training staff in apprenticeship in the context of digitalisation.

There is a whole host of strategies and measures in the Länder, which should also be seen in the context of the calls to action in the National Action Plan with regard to the vocational training of the Länder:

- Status review at all levels,
- Potential of vocational training for sustainable development,
- Establishing vocational schools as sustainable learning spaces,
- Sustainability skills profile,
- Implementation of vocational ESD in curricula and teaching.

The measures laid down in the National Action Plan for these areas are being implemented on an ongoing basis in the Länder. Measures which have proven worthwhile are being further developed by the Länder, and ESD aspects are increasingly being taken into consideration in the consultations and current decisions of the Standing Conference.

In this context, competences relating to sustainable development were included in the “Handreichung für die Erarbeitung von Rahmenlehrplänen der Kultusministerkonferenz für den berufsbezogenen Unterricht in der Berufsschule” (guidelines for the elaboration of framework curricula of the Standing Conference for vocation-related teaching in vocational schools) (publication of the Standing Conference of 14 December 2018) and amended or supplemented accordingly in the Framework Agreement on Vocational Schools (decision by the Standing Conference of 20 September 2018). ESD is thus integrated effectively into all framework curricula of the Standing Conference which come into force as of 2020 and later.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

In continuing and adult education legislation, citizenship education is seen as an equal part of adult/continuing education, alongside general continuing education and vocational continuing education. This legislation describes continuing education as an independent education sector which incorporates continuing general and political education and continuing vocational training and the development of which is the responsibility of the public sector. The term citizenship education or its literal equivalent in German (“staatsbürgerliche Erziehung”) is less used so far. The most common term to refer to the concept of citizenship education is still “politische Bildung” (meaning political education or civic education).

Related topics such as HRE/ESD are covered intensively in the course provision of (mainly the publicly sponsored) adult learning providers such as the community adult education centres, the church-based providers, the union-based providers etc. Statistical data are available for part of the adult learning providers, mainly the community adult education centres. In 2018, the community adult education centres (Volkshochschulen) alone offered a total of 35,341 courses with 516,768 teaching hours and 538,826 students in the programme area “Politics – Society – Environment”. This programme area covers the following subjects: History / Contemporary History; Politics / Civic Engagement; Economics / Law / Finance; Global Learning / Education for Sustainable Development / Environmental Education and Consumer Issues; Pedagogy / Education / Family; Personality Development / Psychology; Diversity / Gender / Interculturalism; Philosophy / Religion / Ethics; Regional and Local Studies / Urban Culture; Natural Sciences; Communication / Media (Source: VHS statistics 2018, URL: <https://www.die-bonn.de/weiterbildung/statistik/vhs-statistik/default.aspx>)

Citizenship education is obligatorily provided to new or recently arrived migrants and refugees in the so called “orientation courses”. The curriculum addresses in particular: political knowledge and civic engagement, tolerance and acceptance of diversity, human rights; gender equality.

One major provider of civic education is the Federal Agency for Civic Education, a subordinate authority under the authority of the Federal Ministry of the Interior. Its mission is to promote understanding of political issues among citizens, to consolidate democratic awareness and strengthen the willingness to participate in politics

The Federal Ministry of Education and Research funds an ESD-Competence-Center (BiNaKom), which provides local authorities assistance to implement ESD at the local level along the lifelong learning chain (<https://www.bne-portal.de/de/bne-kompetenzzentrum-bildung---nachhaltigkeit---kommune-binakom-2471.html>).

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

Several research projects on monitoring and measuring ESD are in place at national and federal state level. Amongst others, since 2015 the Federal Ministry of Education and Research funds a comprehensive monitoring research projects for the implementation of ESD across all education sectors. Results are being continuously published and shared:

https://www.ewi-psy.fu-berlin.de/einrichtungen/weitere/institut-futur/Projekte/ESD_for_2030---English/index.html

<https://www.researchgate.net/project/Monitoring-of-Education-for-Sustainable-Development-ESD-in-Germany>

Members of the German monitoring team are also participating and contributing to the international research project on climate change education (MECCE).

The common goal across all education sectors is to develop indicators to measure ESD at national level in order to integrate ESD into national reporting. The Federal Ministry of Education and Research (BMBF) is funding, among other things, four collaborative research projects that are working on capturing ESD as a cross-cutting task in terms of content and institutions.

Since 2020, the BMBF has been supporting the pilot project “Learning how to teach sustainable development” at the Centre for Education for Sustainable Development of the Heidelberg University of Education, in order to develop ESD further training for lecturers in the field of teacher training.

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers		1	1	
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	1	1	1	
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	1	99	1	
Other activities (please specify):				

I. Any other comments

11 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.

The tables go into extreme detail with regard to different aspects of HRE/GCED/ESD. For a federal country with a decentralised education system such as Germany (and also taking into account school/teacher autonomy and autonomy of HEIs), thoroughly answering these in-depth questions would only be possible through disproportionate efforts. Our responses must therefore be understood as approximations.

More generally, in our view such a detailed questionnaire may not be helpful for measuring SDG 4.7 as it does not deliver meaningful insights, which is also due to the overlapping content of the different aspects/concepts. Other member states will likely encounter similar difficulties in providing accurate responses.